Unit 3 THE TRUMPETS OF CHANGE

WAR

- **Another Day in Paradise (Phil Collins)**
- **War-(Luigi Pirandello)**
- **A Piece of String (- Guy de Maupassant)**

Another Day in Paradise (Phil Collins)

Comprehension questions

A. Read the lines from the song Another Day in Paradise and answer the questions that follow

She calls out to the man on the street
"Sir, can you help me?
It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep
Is there somewhere you can tell me?"
He walks on, doesn't look back
He pretends he can't hear her
Starts to whistle as he crosses the street
Seems embarrassed to be there.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for you,
You and me in paradise
Think about it

1. What does the woman actually need when she calls out to the man on the street?
2. How does the man react to the woman's request for help?
   A) He stops and helps her.
   B) He acts as if he cannot hear her.
   C) He continues walking without responding.
   D) He turns back to look at her.

Choose the correct option:
i. B and C
ii. Only A
iii. All
iv. A and B

3.What does the word 'Paradise' symbolise in the context of the song?
A) The heavenly abode of God
B) The place where commuters live
C) The world of the rich, comfortable, and privileged people

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D) A place filled with pain and suffering
4.Name the poetic device used in the line, ‘He pretends he can’t hear her
5.What does the woman’s condition suggest about her life on the streets?
6.Why does the man start whistling as he crosses the street? What does this action reveal about his attitude?
7.What message does the song convey about society’s response to the poor and the homeless?

SET B

Read the lines from the song *Another Day in Paradise* and answer the questions that follow.

She calls out to the man on the street,
He can see she’s been crying,
She’s got blisters on the soles of her feet
She can’t walk but she’s trying
Oh, think twice, cause it’s just another day for you,
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, cause it’s just another day for you,
You and me in paradise.
Just think about it.

1. What do the lines reveal about the physical condition of the woman?
2. What does the phrase ‘she can’t walk but she’s trying’ suggest about the woman’s struggle?

3. How is the repetition of the line ‘Oh, think twice’ significant in the song?
   A) It adds musical beauty only
   B) It emphasises the message of reflection and responsibility
   C) It describes the woman’s suffering
   D) It shows the happiness of the man
4. What does the word ‘Paradise’ symbolise in these lines?
   A) Heaven
   B) A place of comfort and privilege
   C) A land of suffering
   D) A shelter for the poor
5. Identify the poetic device used in the repetition of the line ‘Oh, think twice’.
6. What message does the poet convey through these lines about society’s attitude towards the homeless?
7. What does the man on the street notice about the woman?
   A) He sees that she has been crying.
   B) He realises she is injured and unable to walk properly.
   C) He understands that she is wealthy.
   D) He thinks she is pretending.

Choose the correct option:
i. A and B

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ii. Only C
iii. B and D
iv. All

APPRECIATION

Read the following lines from the poem ***Another day in Paradise*** and prepare a note of appreciation focusing on the theme, techniques and literary devices

She calls out to the man on the street.
"Sir, can you help me?
It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep,
Is there somewhere you can tell me?"
He walks on, doesn't look back
He pretends he can't hear her
Starts to whistle as he crosses the street
Seems embarrassed to be there.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for you
You and me in paradise,
Think about it.

Phil Collins is a famous English singer, songwriter, and musician known for his meaningful and socially relevant songs. His song "Another Day in Paradise" highlights the harsh realities of modern society. The central theme of the song is social inequality and human indifference towards the poor and homeless. Through this song, the poet strongly criticises people who ignore the suffering of others while living in comfort. The song belongs to the genre of socially conscious lyrical song.

In the song, the poet describes the life of a homeless woman standing on the street, ignored by people who pass by without noticing her pain. She asks for help, but no one listens to her. People continue their daily routines, pretending that they do not see her suffering. The phrase "another day in paradise" is used ironically to highlight the contrast between the privileged and the poor, with the former enjoying comfortable lives and the latter enduring miserable conditions. The song urges listeners to open their eyes and hearts to the pain around them and to show compassion instead of indifference.

The song makes effective use of poetic devices. Irony is clearly seen in the title and the repeated line "another day in paradise," which contrasts with the woman's suffering. Repetition strengthens the message and makes the song more impactful. Imagery helps the listener visualise the lonely woman on the street. The simple and conversational language makes the song easily understandable and emotionally touching.

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Personally, I feel that this song is powerful and thought-provoking because it reminds us of our moral responsibility towards the less fortunate. Phil Collins successfully uses music and words; it serves as an important reminder of our moral obligation to care for those who are less fortunate. Through his music and heartfelt lyrics, Phil Collins successfully engages listeners in a conversation about social conscience, ensuring that the song remains relevant and impactful today.

Answer

Set A

1. Help, shelter, and a place to sleep.
2. i. B and C
3. The world of the comfortable and fortunate people.
4. Personification.
5. A life of hardship, poverty, and homelessness.
6. To avoid involvement; it shows indifference and embarrassment.
7. Society is insensitive and neglects the poor and homeless.

Set B

1. She is physically exhausted, injured, and unable to walk properly.
2. It shows her determination to survive despite pain and hardship.
3. B. It emphasises the message of reflection and responsibility.
4. B.A place of comfort and privilege.
5. Repetition.
6. Society is indifferent and insensitive towards the homeless.
7. i. A and B

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